

Word family: ****shoulder / shoulders / shouldered / shouldering****

****Base word:** shoulder**

****Part of speech:** mainly ****noun**** and ****verb******

****Related forms:****

* ****shoulder**** (n.) — 肩膀；肩部；路肩；山肩；肉類肩部切塊

* ****shoulder**** (v.) — 承擔；肩負；用肩推擠

* ****shouldered**** — 已承擔的；有某種肩形的

* ****shouldering**** — 承擔中；肩負中

* ****broad-shouldered**** — 肩膀寬闊的

* ****shoulder-length**** — 齊肩長度的

****Useful expressions / extensions:****

* ****shoulder the burden****

* ****shoulder responsibility****

* ****shoulder the cost****

* ****shoulder the blame****

* ****shoulder most of the work****

* ****shoulder your way through****

* ****shoulder someone aside****

* ****shoulder to shoulder****

* ****stand shoulder to shoulder****

* ****rub shoulders with****

* ****give someone the cold shoulder****

* ****a chip on your shoulder****

* ****look over your shoulder****

* ****road shoulder****

* ****hard shoulder****

* ****shoulder of a mountain****

* ****shoulder of lamb / pork****

* ****shoulder season****

Meaning in this passage

> In many teams, some employees ****shoulder most of the burden**** while others contribute very little.

Here, ****shoulder**** is a verb meaning:

****to take on and carry a large share of responsibility, work, or difficulty — 承擔；肩負****

The image comes from physically carrying a heavy object on your shoulders.

****中文翻譯：****

在很多團隊中，有些員工****承擔了大部分重擔 / 工作量****，而其他人卻幾乎沒有甚麼貢獻。

So here:

****shoulder the burden = 承擔困難、工作、責任或壓力****

1. ****shoulder (noun : 肩膀) — 肩膀 ; 肩部****

The core literal sense.

Practice 1

> He carried the bag over his ****shoulder****.

他把袋背在****肩膀****上。

Practice 2

> She injured her ****shoulder**** while exercising.

她做運動時弄傷了****肩膀****。

Practice 3

> He put his hand on my ****shoulder****.

他把手放在我的****肩膀****上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder = 手臂與身體上半部連接的位置****

2. ****on your shoulder / over your shoulder — 在肩上 / 越過肩膀****

Practice 1

> She carried the laptop bag ****on her shoulder****.

她把電腦袋****掛在肩上****。

Practice 2

> He looked **over his shoulder**.

他**回頭越過肩膀看了一眼**。

MCQ-ready definition:

over your shoulder = 從肩膀上方向身後看

3. **shoulders (體格：肩膀寬窄) — 肩膀；肩寬**

Practice 1

> He has broad **shoulders**.

他的**肩膀很寬**。

Practice 2

> The jacket is too tight across the **shoulders**.

這件外套的**肩位**太緊。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulders = 身體上半部左右兩側的肩部，亦可描述體格或衣服尺寸

4. **shoulder of a garment — 衣服肩位**

Practice 1

> The **shoulders of the jacket** are slightly too wide.

這件外套的**肩位**稍微太寬。

Practice 2

> The dress has padded **shoulders**.

這件連身裙有**墊肩**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****shoulder = 衣服覆蓋人體肩膀的部分****

5. ****shoulder-length — 齊肩長度的****

Practice 1

> She has ****shoulder-length hair****.

她留着****齊肩長髮****。

Practice 2

> He cut his hair to ****shoulder length****.

他把頭髮剪至****齊肩長度****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder-length = 長度剛好到肩膀的位置****

6. ****shoulder the burden — 承擔重擔****

This is the exact expression in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Some employees ****shoulder most of the burden****.

有些員工****承擔了大部分重擔****。

Practice 2

> A few team members were left to ****shoulder the entire burden****.

只有幾名組員被迫****承擔全部重任****。

Practice 3

> No one person should have to ****shoulder the burden alone****.

不應由一個人獨自****承擔所有重擔****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder the burden = 承擔困難、壓力、責任或大量工作****

7. ****shoulder responsibility — 承擔責任****

Practice 1

> Managers must ****shoulder responsibility**** for difficult decisions.

管理人員必須為艱難決定****承擔責任****。

Practice 2

> She was willing to ****shoulder more responsibility****.

她願意****承擔更多責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder responsibility = 接受並承擔某項職責或其後果****

8. ****shoulder the work / workload — 承擔工作量****

Practice 1

> Two people ended up ****shouldering most of the work****.

最後只有兩個人****承擔了大部分工作****。

Practice 2

> Junior staff should not have to ****shoulder the whole workload****.

初級員工不應該要****承擔全部工作量****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder the work = 負責完成很大部分工作****

9. ****shoulder the cost — 承擔費用 / 成本****

A major figurative extension.

Practice 1

> The company agreed to ****shoulder the cost of repairs****.

公司同意****承擔維修費用****。

Practice 2

> Taxpayers may have to ****shoulder part of the cost****.

納稅人可能需要****承擔部分成本****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder the cost = 負責支付某項費用或經濟負擔****

10. ****shoulder the blame — 承擔責任 / 罪責****

Practice 1

> She unfairly had to ****shoulder the blame**** for the failure.

她不公平地被迫為失敗****承擔責任****。

Practice 2

> One employee should not ****shoulder all the blame****.

不應由一名員工****承擔所有責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder the blame = 接受或被迫承擔對壞結果的責任****

11. ****shoulder a duty / obligation — 肩負義務****

Practice 1

> Parents often ****shoulder many responsibilities****.

父母往往****肩負很多責任****。

Practice 2

> The organisation must **shoulder its obligations**.

機構必須**承擔自己的義務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder a duty/obligation = 承擔必須履行的職責或義務

12. **shoulder (用肩推) — 用肩膀推 ; 擠**

A separate literal verb sense.

Practice 1

> He **shouldered the door open**.

他用**肩膀把門撞開**。

Practice 2

> She **shouldered him aside** and walked past.

她**用肩膀把他擠到一旁**，然後走過去。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder something/someone = 用肩膀推、撞或擠動某物 / 某人

13. **shoulder your way through — 用肩膀擠過 ; 擠出一條路**

Practice 1

> He **shouldered his way through the crowd**.

他在人群中**用肩膀擠出一條路**。

Practice 2

> She had to **shoulder her way through** the packed entrance.

她不得不在擠滿人的入口處**一路擠過去**。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder your way through X = 用身體和肩膀推擠着穿過人群

14. **road shoulder — 路肩**

A major transport sense, especially AmE.

Practice 1

> The driver pulled onto the **shoulder**.

司機把車駛到**路肩**。

Practice 2

> The broken-down car was parked on the **road shoulder**.

故障汽車停在**路肩**上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****road shoulder = 道路車道旁邊供緊急停車或安全用途的邊緣部分****

15. **hard shoulder — 高速公路路肩**

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> The car stopped on the **hard shoulder**.

汽車停在高速公路的**路肩**。

Practice 2

> Do not drive on the **hard shoulder** unless permitted.

除非獲准，否則不要在**高速公路路肩**行駛。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****hard shoulder = BrE: 高速公路主行車線旁供緊急情況使用的硬地帶****

16. **shoulder of a hill / mountain — 山肩；山坡較平緩突出的部分**

Practice 1

> The path crosses the **shoulder of the mountain**.

小徑橫過山的**山肩**。

Practice 2

> Snow remained on the northern **shoulder** of the peak.

山峰北面的**山肩**仍有積雪。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder of a mountain = 山坡上像人的肩膀般向外突出或較平緩的部分

17. **shoulder of meat** — 肩部肉；肩肉

Practice 1

> We cooked a **shoulder of lamb**.

我們煮了一塊**羊肩肉**。

Practice 2

> Pork **shoulder** is suitable for slow cooking.

豬肩肉很適合慢煮。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder = 從動物肩部切下的一塊肉

18. **shoulder to shoulder** — 肩並肩；並肩

Can be literal or figurative.

Practice 1

> The passengers stood **shoulder to shoulder**.

乘客們**肩並肩**站着。

Practice 2

> The two teams worked ****shoulder to shoulder**** during the crisis.

兩個團隊在危機期間****並肩合作****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shoulder to shoulder = 緊靠在一起；figuratively，一起合作或共同面對困難****

19. ****stand shoulder to shoulder with — 與.....並肩；堅定支持****

Practice 1

> Colleagues stood ****shoulder to shoulder**** to finish the project.

同事們****並肩合作****完成項目。

Practice 2

> She promised to stand ****shoulder to shoulder with her team****.

她承諾會和團隊****並肩面對困難****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stand shoulder to shoulder with X = 與 X 團結一致、共同面對問題或支持對方****

20. ****rub shoulders with — 與.....接觸 / 來往****

A useful idiom.

Practice 1

> At the conference, students could ****rub shoulders with industry leaders****.

學生在會議上可以和業界領袖****近距離接觸交流****。

Practice 2

> He regularly ****rubs shoulders with senior executives****.

他經常和高層行政人員****來往接觸****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rub shoulders with X = 與某類人，尤其是有名望或地位的人近距離接觸或社交****

21. ****give someone the cold shoulder — 冷待某人；故意不理睬****

Practice 1

> After the argument, she ****gave him the cold shoulder****.

爭吵後，她****故意冷待他****。

Practice 2

> I tried to speak to them, but they ****gave me the cold shoulder****.

我嘗試和他們說話，但他們****故意不理我****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****give someone the cold shoulder = 刻意對某人冷淡、不友善或不理睬****

22. ****a chip on your shoulder — 心有不忿；容易覺得被冒犯****

A common idiom.

Practice 1

> He seems to have ****a chip on his shoulder**** about his background.

他似乎因自己的背景而一直****心有不忿****。

Practice 2

> Don't go into the discussion with ****a chip on your shoulder****.

不要帶着****一肚子不忿****去參加討論。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****have a chip on your shoulder = 因過去的不公平或自卑感而容易生氣、覺得別人看不起自己****

23. **look over your shoulder — 回頭看；提防身後**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 1

> She **looked over her shoulder** before crossing the road.

她過馬路前**回頭看了一眼**。

Practice 2

> He was constantly **looking over his shoulder** after receiving the threat.

收到威脅後，他一直**提心吊膽、提防身後**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****look over your shoulder = literal: 回頭看；figurative: 因害怕危險或競爭而保持警覺****

24. **have broad shoulders — 能承受責任 / 壓力**

A figurative extension of physical broad shoulders.

Practice 1

> She has **broad shoulders** and can handle criticism.

她很**能承受壓力和批評**。

Practice 2

> Leaders need **broad shoulders**.

領導者需要有**承擔重任的能力**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****have broad shoulders = figurative: 有能力承受責任、批評或巨大壓力****

25. **shoulder season — 旅遊淡旺季之間的過渡季節**

A useful modern travel/business compound.

Practice 1

> Hotels are often cheaper during the **shoulder season**.

在**淡旺季之間的過渡季節**，酒店通常較便宜。

Practice 2

> We prefer travelling in the **shoulder season**.

我們較喜歡在**旅遊淡旺季交界期**出行。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoulder season = 介乎旅遊旺季和淡季之間的時期

Important distinction 1: **shoulder vs carry**

carry

physically hold and move something, or broadly bear something.

shoulder

figuratively emphasizes **taking a burden onto yourself**.

> carry a bag

> 拿 / 背袋

> shoulder responsibility

> 肩負責任

For abstract burdens, **shoulder** sounds heavier and more responsibility-focused.

Important distinction 2: **shoulder vs bear**

Very relevant.

bear a burden

endure or carry a burden.

shoulder a burden

take on responsibility for carrying it.

> bear the emotional burden

> 承受情緒負擔

> shoulder the workload

> 承擔工作量

They overlap, but **shoulder** often emphasizes **taking responsibility for the load**.

Important distinction 3: **shoulder vs take on**

take on responsibility

neutral: accept responsibility.

shoulder responsibility

more vivid; suggests the responsibility is heavy.

> take on extra work

> 接手額外工作

> shoulder a heavy burden

> 肩負沉重責任

Important distinction 4: **shoulder vs assume responsibility**

assume responsibility

formal, neutral.

shoulder responsibility

more metaphorical and often emphasizes difficulty or weight.

Important distinction 5: **shoulder vs contribute**

This is central to your passage.

shoulder work

be responsible for carrying a large amount of it.

contribute

add some amount to the shared result.

The passage contrasts:

> some workers **shoulder most of the burden**

> others **contribute very little**

So the first group carries the load; the second barely adds to it.

Important distinction 6: **shoulder the burden vs share the burden**

shoulder the burden

carry it.

share the burden

divide it among multiple people.

The teamwork problem occurs because:

only a few people shoulder a burden that should be shared.

Important distinction 7: **shoulder the blame vs be to blame**

be to blame

actually be responsible for causing the problem.

shoulder the blame

accept or be made to carry the blame.

Someone can unfairly **shoulder the blame** even when they are not actually **to blame**.

Important distinction 8: ****shoulder the cost vs pay****

****pay****

neutral financial action.

****shoulder the cost****

emphasizes bearing a financial burden.

> The company paid the bill.

> 公司付了帳。

> The company shouldered the cost.

> 公司****承擔了這筆成本負擔****。

Important distinction 9: ****road shoulder vs pavement / sidewalk****

****road shoulder****

edge beside a roadway.

****pavement**** (BrE) / ****sidewalk**** (AmE)

pedestrian path.

A road shoulder is not necessarily designed for pedestrians.

Important distinction 10: ****hard shoulder vs road shoulder****

****hard shoulder****

specific BrE motorway term.

****road shoulder****

broader international/AmE term for the road edge.

Important distinction 11: ****shoulder to shoulder literal vs figurative****

Literal:

bodies physically close together.

Figurative:

united in cooperation or support.

> stand shoulder to shoulder

> = ****並肩作戰 / 團結一致****

Important distinction 12: ****cold shoulder****

This has nothing to do with body temperature.

It is a fixed idiom:

****give someone the cold shoulder = 故意冷落某人****

Important distinction 13: ****chip on your shoulder****

This does not mean there is literally something on the person's shoulder.

It describes:

****persistent resentment or defensiveness, often because someone feels badly treated or inferior****

Important distinction 14: ****shoulder season****

This is not a physical shoulder sense.

The metaphor places the period on either “side” of the peak season:

> peak season → shoulder season → low season

It is especially common in travel.

Important distinction 15: ****shoulder in your passage****

Here, the physical body-part metaphor is very strong:

****work/responsibility = a heavy object****

****employee = person carrying it on their shoulders****

So:

> ****shoulder most of the burden****

means more than merely:

> “do some work.”

It suggests:

****carry an unfairly large share of a heavy responsibility****

Family-extension note

****Shoulder**** begins with the physical body part:

****the part of the body that traditionally carries weight****

That gives rise naturally to several branches:

1. ****body****

- * shoulder
- * broad shoulders
- * shoulder-length

2. ****carrying responsibility****

- * shoulder the burden
- * shoulder responsibility
- * shoulder costs

3. ****physical pushing****

- * shoulder someone aside
- * shoulder your way through

4. **road geography**

- * road shoulder
- * hard shoulder

5. **natural shape**

- * shoulder of a mountain

6. **food**

- * pork/lamb shoulder

7. **human relationships**

- * shoulder to shoulder
- * cold shoulder
- * rub shoulders
- * chip on shoulder

8. **travel**

- * shoulder season

For your passage, the exact branch is:

shoulder = carry and take responsibility for a heavy share of the team's work

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
shoulder (body)	肩膀；肩部	body part	
shoulder of clothing	衣服肩位	garment	
shoulder-length	齊肩長度	length	
shoulder the burden	承擔重擔	responsibility/load	
shoulder responsibility	肩負責任	duty	
shoulder the workload	承擔工作量	work	
shoulder the cost	承擔成本	financial burden	
shoulder the blame	承擔責任 / 罪責	blame	
shoulder someone aside	用肩把某人擠開	physical push	

shoulder your way through	用肩擠過	force through	
road shoulder	路肩	road edge	
hard shoulder	高速公路路肩	BrE motorway	
shoulder of a mountain	山肩	landform	
pork/lamb shoulder	豬肩 / 羊肩肉	meat cut	
shoulder to shoulder	肩並肩；並肩合作	unity	
rub shoulders with	與.....接觸來往	social contact	
cold shoulder	冷待；冷落	rejection	
chip on your shoulder	心有不忿	resentment	
look over your shoulder	回頭看 / 提防	caution	
broad shoulders	能承受重任	figurative strength	
shoulder season	淡旺季之間	travel period	

For your original sentence

> In many teams, some employees ****shoulder most of the burden**** while others contribute very little.

Here:

****shoulder most of the burden = 少數員工要負責完成大部分工作，承受大部分責任和壓力****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 在很多團隊中，有些員工****承擔了大部分重擔 / 工作量****，而其他人卻貢獻甚少。

The cleanest contrast is:

> ****do the work**** = 做工作，中性

> ****take on responsibility**** = 接下責任

> ****bear a burden**** = 承受重擔

> ****shoulder the burden**** = ****把沉重的責任「扛在肩上」**，尤其強調自己承擔了很大一部分******

That physical image makes ****shoulder**** especially effective in this paragraph about unequal teamwork.